

EU to deepen ties with Canada as 'trusted supplier' of energy and minerals, draft document says

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EU to deepen ties with Canada as 'trusted supplier' of energy and minerals, draft document says

By Camille Gijs · Sep 29, 2026, 6:26 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — The European Union wants to team up with Canada to expand cooperation in critical minerals and the supply of liquefied natural gas, with the bloc hailing Ottawa as a “trusted supplier” of both, according to extracts of a draft summit joint statement seen by POLITICO.

The two sides plan to say at their end-October summit in Montreal that they want to speed up investment in critical mineral projects, strengthen supply chains and improve security of supply, including through stockpiling critical resources to mitigate “market fluctuations and geopolitical impacts.”

The EU and Canada have been seeking to shore up their strategic ties as they grapple with the fallout from U.S. President Donald Trump’s trade war. European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen this month proposed inviting Canada to become an associate member of the EU, triggering an immediate threat by Trump to impose tariffs .

“We are joining forces voluntarily ... We will create a tech alliance. We will integrate defence industrial bases. We will make the Arctic a flagship joint project. We will work on energy, critical minerals and batteries. On AI, quantum, cyber and economic security,” von der Leyen said in her State of the Union speech on Sept. 15.

The efforts echo Ottawa’s push to portray itself as a reliable supplier of critical minerals to counter China’s dominance. Critical raw materials were among the areas Prime Minister Mark Carney said he wanted to prioritize for cooperation with Brussels in a speech to European lawmakers the day after von der Leyen’s address.

“Building on the EIB engagement, Canada and the EU will identify commitments for export of Canadian critical minerals to Europe,” the draft adds, referring to efforts by the European Investment Bank to boost investments in critical minerals projects .

Brussels and Ottawa also want to “assess opportunities to expand energy connectivity and strengthen long-term energy cooperation,” the document says, through a feasibility study on exporting Canadian LNG to Europe that would examine the “environmental sustainability” of long-term purchase agreements.

Europe is paying high prices for gas as disruptions to Qatari LNG exports tighten the global market, while low inventories have left governments and utilities scrambling to fill storage facilities ahead of

winter. Following a visit to Canada , German Foreign Minister Johann Wadephul said over the weekend that Berlin wanted to secure more LNG and saw Canada as a supplier to help diversify away from Russia.

The EU relies heavily on China for several critical raw materials and their processing, particularly the rare earths used in everything from wind turbines and electric motors to defense technology. Canada has significant deposits of lithium, nickel, graphite and rare earths and is seeking to build up processing capacity as well.

The joint declaration will be released by the EU and Canada at their Montreal summit Oct. 29-30. It will be discussed by top EU envoys on Wednesday and is still expected to undergo changes ahead of the gathering.

Ben Munster and Carlo Martuscelli contributed reporting.

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